



Elon Musk's 'Free Bird'

According to the Tesla CEO, he has 'freed' Twitter after acquiring the social network for \$44 billion. Or has he?

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► **AFTER MUCH ADO**, Elon Musk is the official owner of Twitter. The Tesla chief, who first disclosed his 9.2 per cent Twitter shareholding in April, later going on to make a hostile bid for the social network, closed his \$44-billion buyout just a day before a Delaware Chancery Court-ordered deadline of October 29. Before taking office, Musk tweeted: "The bird is freed".

His tenure as Twitter's new CEO (or what he calls "Chief Twit") began with the firings of incumbent CEO Parag Agrawal, CFO Ned Segal, and the company's legal affairs and policy chief Vijaya Gadde, who's infamous for issuing former US President Donald Trump a lifetime ban. Twitter Chairman Bret Taylor has also exited the firm.

Back in April, before things soured between Agrawal and Musk, the former had called the Tesla boss "both a passionate believer and intense critic of

the service which is exactly what we need on @Twitter, and in the boardroom". Musk later expressed concerns over Twitter's content moderation policies and its large share of spam accounts—a key metric that determines advertiser reach—even wanting to pull out of the deal. Twitter sued Musk for backtracking on the proposed buyout, which it termed "legally binding".

After several months of to-and-fro and courtroom drama, the world's richest person took the microblogging platform private, paying \$54.20 per share, which he reckons is a lot. Twitter shares finally

MUSK'S LITMUS TEST WOULD BE TO GROW TWITTER WHILE SIMULTANEOUSLY ENSURING ITS LOYAL USER BASE IS RETAINED